

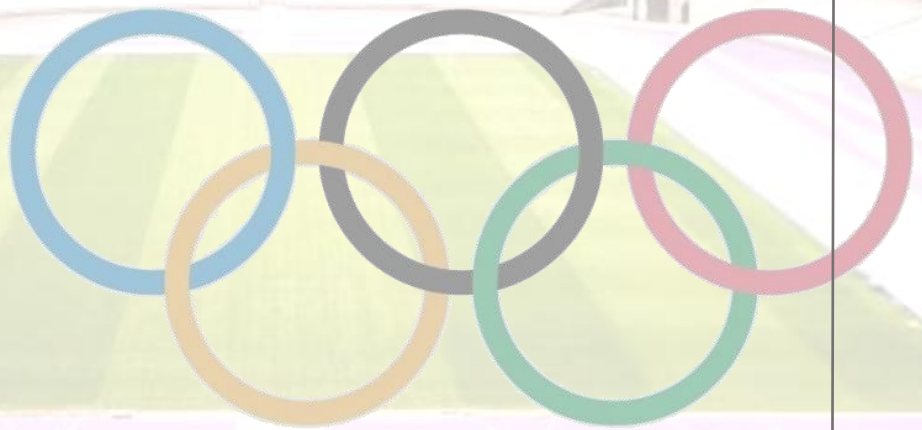


2024 Asia Youth Leaders

OLYMPICS&PEACE: Promoting Unity and Environmental Awareness

Author: Liu Quanlin from Tanggu NO.1 High School

Jun. 2024



CONTENTS

Chapter 1	Abstract&Key Words	3
Chapter 2	Background Introduction	4
Chapter 3	Plan of Solutions	5
3.1	Reusing Constructions to Reduce Carbon Emissions	
3.2	Promoting Energy Conservation	
Chapter 4	Challenges	9
Chapter 5	Feasibility Analysis	10
Chapter 6	Expected Effects&Significance	11
Chapter 7	Postscript	12

Chapter 1 Abstract&Key Words

More than 2000 years ago, the first ancient Olympic Games was held in Ancient Greece. In 1896, the first modern Olympics was held in Athens, from then on the Olympic spirit was gradually formed--faster, higher and stronger. Its significance is more than about sports. **It's about people from different cultural backgrounds gathering together to communicate with others in a peaceful way.**

Today's world has met much more challenges than the past. In 2015, the United Nations made the 17 Sustainable



Development Goals, among them the 11th goal “Sustainable cities and communities” plays an important role.

As a worldwide sports event, the Olympic Games not only enhances competing, but also reflects the result of **implementing the theory of sustainable development in various aspects**, including conserving energy during competitions and reusing constructions after the event. With the Paris 2024 Olympic Games upcoming, this plan is to be made to **discuss practical solutions about it and work towards a more peaceful world.**

Key Words: Olympic Games, Peace, Sustainable Development, Energy Conservation, Construction Reuse

Chapter 2 Background Introduction

In preparation for this plan, I conducted a questionnaire about people's environmental protection awareness. The survey involved over 100 participants, of which 65 responses were confirmed to be valid.

When asked about **the potential impact of hosting large-scale events like the Olympic Games**, 66% of the participants stated that it could be rather beneficial. (Diagram 2-1)

您认为奥运会等大型活动的举办对于环境保护的影响更多是？

选项	小计	比例
可能促进环境保护	43	66.15%
可能导致环境污染	22	33.85%
本题有效填写人次	65	

diagram 2-1

奥运会等活动主要会在哪些方面导致环境破坏？ [多选题]

选项	小计	比例
自然资源的大量消耗	17	77.27%
废弃物和污染物的排放	18	81.82%
对当地生态系统的破坏	10	45.45%
土地资源的占用和破坏	14	63.64%
水资源污染	6	27.27%
噪声污染	12	54.55%
其他	0	0%
本题有效填写人次	22	

diagram 2-2

奥运会等活动主要会在哪些方面促进环境保护？ [多选题]

选项	小计	比例
提供相关平台进行宣传教育	35	81.4%
绿色材料、技术的应用	42	97.67%
环境保护标准的制定与实施	34	79.07%
国际交流与合作的推动	31	72.09%
公众参与和意识提升	27	62.79%
其他	0	0%
本题有效填写人次	43	

diagram 2-3

Their main supporting reasons include *the use of eco-friendly materials*(97%), *providing platforms to promote related theory*(81%) and else. For those who believed hosting such events is rather harmful to the environment, they also cited their reasons. *The emission of waste and pollutants* takes the top position(81%), while *the consumption of natural resources*(77%) is also on the list. (Diagrams 2-2, 2-3)

Participants also rated the correlation between environmental protection and world peace, giving it a score of 7.02 out of 10, while the average rating for the importance of environmental

您认为环境保护的重要程度有多大 [矩阵滑动条]

行标题	平均值
0 为最小, 10 为最大	8.26
	小计: 8.26 平均: 8.26

diagram 2-4

您认为环境保护与世界和平的关联性大小? [矩阵滑动条]

行标题	平均值
0 为最小, 10 为最大	7.02
	小计: 7.02 平均: 7.02

diagram 2-5

protection was 8.26 out of 10. (Diagrams 2-4, 2-5) This indicates that most people agree environmental protection is partially connected to world peace.

Overall, it is crucial to **prioritize eco-friendly measures during large-scale events to promote sustainability and contribute to maintaining world peace.**

Chapter 3 Plan of Solutions

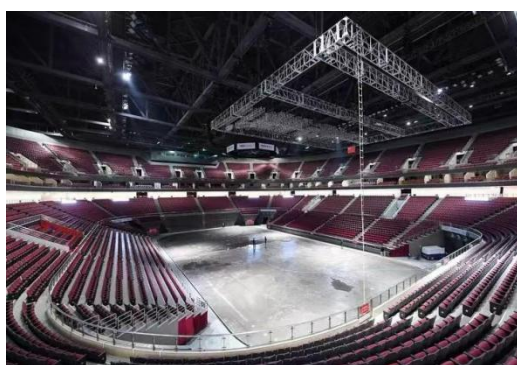
From various aspects of an event, I have chosen to focus on **the Olympic constructions** to demonstrate the effectiveness of environmentally friendly measures during and after the event. Specifically, the Beijing 2022 Winter Olympic Games serve as an example of low carbon emissions and sustainable development. The next step in this plan involves finding ways to implement and promote these measures in future construction projects.

3.1 Reusing Constructions to Reduce Carbon Emissions

In Jan. 2022, the organizing committee for the Beijing Winter Olympics officially released the “Beijing 2022 Winter Olympics Low Carbon Management Report”, introducing the effectiveness of low-carbon management for the Beijing Winter Olympics in detail.



Beijing 2022 Winter Olympics and Paralympics Low Carbon Management Report



renovated Wukesong Sports Arena
approximately 30,000 tons of carbon dioxide compared to the reconstruction of venues.

According to the report, a large amount of greenhouse gas emissions was prevented by **taking advantage of existing constructions**. This can reduce greenhouse gas emissions by

In my opinion, reusing existing constructions not only saves money, but also benefits the environment. It's worthwhile to mention that renovation of the constructions includes both *sports venues* and *athlete apartments*. After an event closes, the apartments can be refurnished into hotels, public housing or official spaces, among other options. This approach has the potential to **enhance resource efficiency and contribute to the advancement of social welfare and world peace.**

3.2 Promoting Energy Conservation

About 500,000 years ago, humans learned to use fire, which was a huge progress in the history of human civilization. In the second half of the 19th century, the first energy conversion in human history occurred, and the world entered “The Coal Age”. While people benefit from modern energy, the **contamination of gas, water and land resources** has become more severe. As a renowned event, the Olympics consumes a substantial amount of energy and leads to environmental destruction.

The organizing committee of the 2020 Tokyo Olympics and Paralympics in Japan released data, stating that the **carbon dioxide emissions** generated from **venue construction and event operations** are approximately 3 million tons.



Tokyo 2020 Olympics opening ceremony

The shortage of energy can also lead to regional conflicts and wars.



oil extraction

The Iran-Iraq War and the Gulf War are partially relevant to oil contest.

These wars involve a large number of innocent civilians and **seriously**

undermine world peace.

When it comes to promoting energy conservation in sports venues, several solutions can be considered. First and foremost, **advanced technology** can be utilized to reduce carbon emissions and environmental pollution. It is also recommended to use **eco-friendly materials and techniques**. Apart from that, governments and organizations can also play a significant role. By **establishing specific criteria**, organizing committees of the events can actively seek ways to promote energy conservation.

The 13th of the UN Sustainable Development Goals is “Climate Action”. Climate change is disrupting national economies and affecting lives and livelihoods, especially for the most vulnerable. To address climate change, conserving energy is a crucial part, as



the 13th goal

publicizing it in large-scale sports events can make a huge impact on a **cleaner, more harmonious and peaceful future** for us all.

Chapter 4 Challenges

In Chapter 3, we have discussed the possible solutions for environmentally friendly measures of the Olympic construction. Still, some unsolved challenges may left.

Initially, **promoting these solutions may meet resistance to change**. People including investors, contractors and local communities may be accustomed to traditional methods. We have to take more actions to raise public awareness towards environmental protection in order to get their permission to promote the measures.

Additionally, **costs of advanced technology are high**. Hosting an Olympic event is well-known for its high cost. The most expensive Olympic Games in history were the 2014 Sochi Winter Olympics, which cost nearly \$50 billion. Therefore, the use of advanced technology may increase the cost of hosting an event. To get rid of the situation, researchers should increase their research in this area, and the government and other institutions should provide financial support.

Ultimately, **various aspects are threatening world peace**. Deep-rooted ethnic or religious tensions can fuel conflicts. Weak governance, corruption, and lack of political stability in certain regions can hinder efforts to establish and maintain peaceful societies. Addressing these challenges requires proactive diplomacy, conflict resolution efforts and a commitment to foster mutual understanding.

Chapter 5 Feasibility Analysis

5.1 Reusing Constructions to Reduce Carbon Emissions

Feasibility index: 6/10

Some old venues are outdated and cannot be renovated to hold a worldwide event. However, the use of advanced technology can help to improve resource efficiency.

5.2 Using eco-friendly materials and techniques

Feasibility index: 8/10

The relevant stakeholders, if encouraged, will be willing to use green materials and contribute to sustainability. We need to raise their awareness through publicity measures and decrease the cost of these materials and techniques.

5.3 Establishing specific criteria

Feasibility index: 9/10

With an increasing number of international conferences addressing on environmental protection, governments will be willing to take actions, such as establishing standards, to make an impact.



2024 Paris Olympics Stadium



green construction material in Shanghai

Chapter 6 Expected Effects&Significance

Having existed for over a century, the Olympics have survived two World Wars, boycotts, the Munich tragedy and doping scandals. Sport, after all, can hardly avoid the impact of the wide world in which it exists.



the upcoming 2024 Paris Olympics

As the modern world evolves rapidly, it's crucial to consider our collective future. The Olympics offers us a valuable platform to promote unity and peace, demonstrating the unity of humanity and the ability to confront challenges together.

Peace has been a pursuit since ancient times. After the industrial revolution, environmental problems have become more and more severe, which increased the threat to world peace. We MUST take action now to make changes, no matter how small they may be.

Focusing on the construction of the Olympic Games, this plan aims to find solutions for sustainable development. It is fully based on surveys and references. I hope that by implementing the plan, the Olympics can set an example to promote environmental awareness and contribute to world peace. We can expect a brighter future for sports and other fields, where sustainability, quality and peace are all achieved. I believe that in the near future, the vision, or a perfect dream, can become a reality.

Chapter 7 Postscript

How time flies!

I still remember the time when I stood on the stage of the Asia Youth Leaders 2023 Tianjin Finals, presenting my immature plan in front of experts and other candidates. It was the time when I gave my first glimpse into Environmental Engineering. A year has passed, and now I've made this plan with my improved ability. As an enthusiast of English, sports, and environmental protection, I have gained valuable insights under the theme "Olympics and Peace" this year. Researching so far in this field, I came to realize that our strengths, if gathered together, can make a difference and work towards a better future for human beings. As a youth leader, I believe it's my responsibility to do so.

I would like to express my special thanks to my friend Yining for providing valuable suggestions on the cover design. I also want to extend my sincere gratitude to Ms. Li Chang'ai and other geography teachers for their guidance in selecting the topic. Additionally, I am grateful to Ms. Liu Qingnan for her assistance with essay writing. I would also like to thank all the participants in the survey. My heartfelt thanks go to Tanggu NO.1 High School for providing me with the opportunity to showcase myself at the Asia Youth Leaders 2024 platform.

Thank you for taking your time to read this plan, and I hope you can take me into consideration.